

SOP — Direct Mail Roll-out Plan

Audience: Aaron (decision-maker on spend), Mike (executor of the day-to-day flow).

Purpose: Phased plan to roll out direct mail cadences without burning \$5K+/month on bad data. Mail is expensive — get the data right before you press the button.

The economic reality

Metric	Number
Mail cost per piece (handwritten, personalized)	~\$1.75
Daily SiftStack record volume (steady state)	~150 records
Daily mail spend if 100% mailability	~\$262/day
Monthly mail spend if 100%	~\$5,250/month
Realistic mail spend at 70% mailability + once-per-record	~\$3,500/month
Industry response rate on cold direct mail	0.5%–2%
Required deals to break even (assume \$20K avg margin)	~1 deal every 6 months at \$5K spend

Translation: Mail is profitable IF the data is clean AND the mailing matches the right segment. **Don't blast every record.** Mail is the most expensive channel — make it the most selective.

The 4-week ramp plan

Week 1 — Verify autonomous daily flow (NO MAIL)

Today through next Friday.

Goal: confirm the daily 6 AM autonomous run produces clean data for 7 consecutive days.

Activities:

- Mike works leads via SMS + phone, NOT mail
- Aaron monitors data quality via Friday Weekly Review
- Verify the 5 mailability filters (below) on every record's data

Mailability filters to validate:

Filter	Field	Expected value	If wrong:
Address validated	dpv_match_code	Y (USPS confirmed)	Drop from mail; Smarty rejected
Mailable flag	mailable	yes	Pipeline computed; if "", drop
First/last name parsed	Owner First Name , Owner Last Name	non-empty	"Dear LONG, WILLIAM" looks like spam — drop
Mailing address present	Mailing Street Address	non-empty	Mail goes to executor's mailing addr (not property)
Decision maker verified living	decision_maker_status	verified_living	Don't mail dead people; Tracerfy + obituary cross-check

Decision point at end of Week 1:

- If <80% of records pass all 5 filters → fix the gap before mailing (Week 2 task)
- If 80%+ pass → green light Week 2 mail prep

Week 2 — Fix gaps + soft-launch infrastructure (NO MAIL YET)

Goal: Hit 95%+ mailability on the daily batch.

Likely fixes needed (we already know):

1. **Name parser** — yesterday's run had 58/144 records (40%) with unparsed first/last names. Phase 11 task.
2. **Tax Sale records** — 40 records/week with no preset assignment. Decide: build `FTM_TaxSale_*` presets OR filter at scraper level.
3. **Lis Pendens scrapers** — Mike has empty `FTM_LP_*` presets waiting for data. Phase 9 candidate.
4. **Direct mail vendor selection** — pick one (see "Vendor decision matrix" below).

Infrastructure tasks:

- Set up direct mail vendor account
- Design the mail piece (handwritten yellow letter is the standard for distress mail)
- Set up the mail-trigger sequence in DataSift (likely "Day 5+ no SMS response → flag mailable → auto-route to mail vendor")
- Hire the caller (per Aaron's plan) — onboard them on SOPs

Week 3 — Soft-launch (50 pieces, 1 segment)

Goal: Validate response rate on a small batch before scaling spend.

Pick: Montgomery County probate (highest volume + highest motivation segment).

Filter:

- Tag: `ftm-probate` AND `montgomery`

- DPV match: Y
- Mailable: yes
- First/Last name: parsed
- Tier (phone): 1, 2, or 3 (don't mail Tier 4-5 until you trust the data)
- Status: New OR Contacted (not Interested+ — those need calls, not mail)

Cadence:

- 1 piece per record
- Handwritten yellow letter, addressed to Decision Maker (executor)
- Reference the decedent's name in the body
- Include Aaron's number + Wright Home Offer brand

Spend: $50 \times \$1.75 = \87

Track:

- Calls received from mail (have a tracking number on the piece)
- Letters returned undeliverable (DPV failure rate)
- Conversion to "Interested" status within 21 days
- Any negative responses (don't mail again)

Week 4 — Scale the proven segment (200-300 pieces, 1-2 segments)

If Week 3 metrics:

- **Response rate >0.5%:** Scale Montgomery probate to all daily records, add Franklin probate
- **Response rate 0.25%-0.5%:** Stay at Montgomery probate, refine the message
- **Response rate <0.25%:** Stop mailing, debug the mail piece + targeting

Scale to:

- All probate records (Mont + Franklin) — ~30/week
- All Tier 1+2 foreclosure records — ~80/week
- Mail spend: ~\$200/week = \$800/month

Week 5+ — Full ramp (continuous)

Steady-state mail program:

- All FTM_ *preset matches that pass mailability filters*
- $\sim 150 \text{ pieces/week} \times \$1.75 = \sim \$1,050/\text{week} = \sim \$4,200/\text{month}^*$
- Coordinate with Mike's SMS + caller's phone work — mail is the 3rd touch in the niche sequential flow
- Adjust messaging by segment (probate vs foreclosure vs tax sale)

Vendor decision

Use OpenLetter (DataSift's native integrated mail house). It's the right choice for SiftStack from Day 1, not a future migration step:

- **Native DataSift integration** — sequences trigger mail directly from records; no CSV export/upload friction
- **Variable substitution from DataSift custom fields** — Sheriff Sale Held Date, Confirmation Hearing Date, Decedent Name, etc. populate automatically
- **Tracking flows back into DataSift activity** — response calls, returned mail, opt-outs all log against the record
- **Cadence automation** — Day-N triggers fire from the sequence, no manual reupload
- **A/B variants** — supported within a single cadence for testing message variants

The earlier plan to start with YellowLetters.com (CSV upload) and migrate later was inferior — OpenLetter is already inside Sift, no migration needed. **All mail templates and cadences live in [SOP-MAIL-TEMPLATES.md](#).**

(For reference only — the alternatives we considered before OpenLetter became the chosen path:)

Vendor	Cost/piece	Min order	Handwritten?	API integration	Best for
OpenLetter (chosen)	per DataSift contract	per contract	Yes (varies by template)	Native DataSift integration	All SiftStack volume
YellowLetters.com	\$1.65-1.95	50	Yes (real ink)	CSV upload only	(deferred)
Click2Mail	\$0.85-1.15	1	No (printed)	Full REST API	(deferred — high volume)

Mail templates and cadences

All mail templates and per-distress cadences (probate, foreclosure lis pendens, foreclosure sheriff sale, redemption window) live in [SOP-MAIL-TEMPLATES.md](#).

That doc is the source of truth for:

- Per-distress cadence design (which piece fires on which day)
- Full template body text (copy-paste into OpenLetter)
- DataSift custom-field → OpenLetter variable mapping
- Stop-mail triggers (status changes, returned mail, opt-outs)
- A/B variant testing patterns

This doc (SOP-DIRECT-MAIL-PLAN) stays focused on economics: spend ramp, mailability filters, ROI math, response-rate targets, vendor decision.

Active model (2026-04-29): Entry-mail-first via global `Mail_On_Entry` sequence. Every mailable record gets ONE first-touch mail piece on Day 0 (captures first-to-market window — Tyler/REISift teaching). Preset cadences handle Day 30 / 60 / 90+ follow-ups on records that don't convert. See [MIKE-MAIL-ENTRY-SETUP.md](#) for build instructions. Spend math below revised to fit this model.

Revised spend math (entry-mail-first model)

At steady state (~Day 7+ post-dedup):

- Entry mail: ~50 NEW records/day × 22 weekdays × \$1.75 = **~\$1,925/month**
- Preset cadence follow-up (Day 30 / 60 / 120 mail on non-converted records): ~300–500 pieces/month × \$1.50 = **~\$450–750/month**
- **Total: ~\$2,375–2,675/month** — fits the \$3k Phase 1 budget

Trade-off vs the original "mail only top-tier records" model: same total spend, BUT every mailable record gets a first-to-market touch automatically. Higher response rate from Day 0 timing offsets not-targeting-only-top-tier. Sub-tier presets remain a Phase 2 option if data later shows clear motivation gradient worth segmenting on.

Tracking & ROI math

For every batch of mail sent, track in a Google Sheet:

Date	Segment	Pieces	Spend	Calls received	Conversations	Offers made	Closed	Cost/Closed

The real number that matters: Cost per closed deal.

If \$87 of mail (Week 3) generates 1 closed deal at \$20K margin → **ROI = 230x**. That's the unit economics.
If \$87 of mail generates 0 closed deals over 90 days → bad targeting or bad message; reduce or pause.

Risks & mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Mailing dead people	DOD sanity check (3-yr window) + obituary verification before mail; require <code>decision_maker_status = verified_living</code>
Mailing wrong address	Smarty DPV match = Y required; reject S/N matches
Mailing too soon (annoying recipients)	14-day delay between SMS sequences and first mail piece; 30-day delay between mail pieces to same record
Spending too much before validating	Hard cap at \$1,000 mail spend until first deal closes; review weekly
Negative response (recipient angry)	Tag <code>do_not_mail</code> permanently; immediate respect; respond personally if they call/email

Stop-mail criteria (when to pause)

Pause the mail program if any of these hit:

- **3+ DPV failures** in a single batch — data quality issue, fix before continuing
 - **Response rate <0.25% over 200 pieces** — message or targeting is wrong
 - **>1% negative response** ("stop mailing me") — segmentation is too aggressive or list is contaminated
 - **Tracerfy/Trestle credits exhausted** — fix enrichment first; mail without verified addresses is wasted spend
 - **Mike or caller can't keep up with inbound** — mail-driven calls require capacity
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See also

- [SOP-DAILY-OPERATIONS.md](#) — daily flow context
 - [SOP-LEAD-QUALIFICATION.md](#) — qualification gating BEFORE mail
 - [SOP-WEEKLY-REVIEW.md](#) — weekly review picks up mail metrics
 - [SOP-CALL-SCRIPTS.md](#) — script for inbound calls from mail responders
 - [SOP-REDEMPTION-WINDOW.md](#) — redemption-window mail piece (Phase 2 only; FedEx 2-day for `redemption_closing` records, NOT standard mail)
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